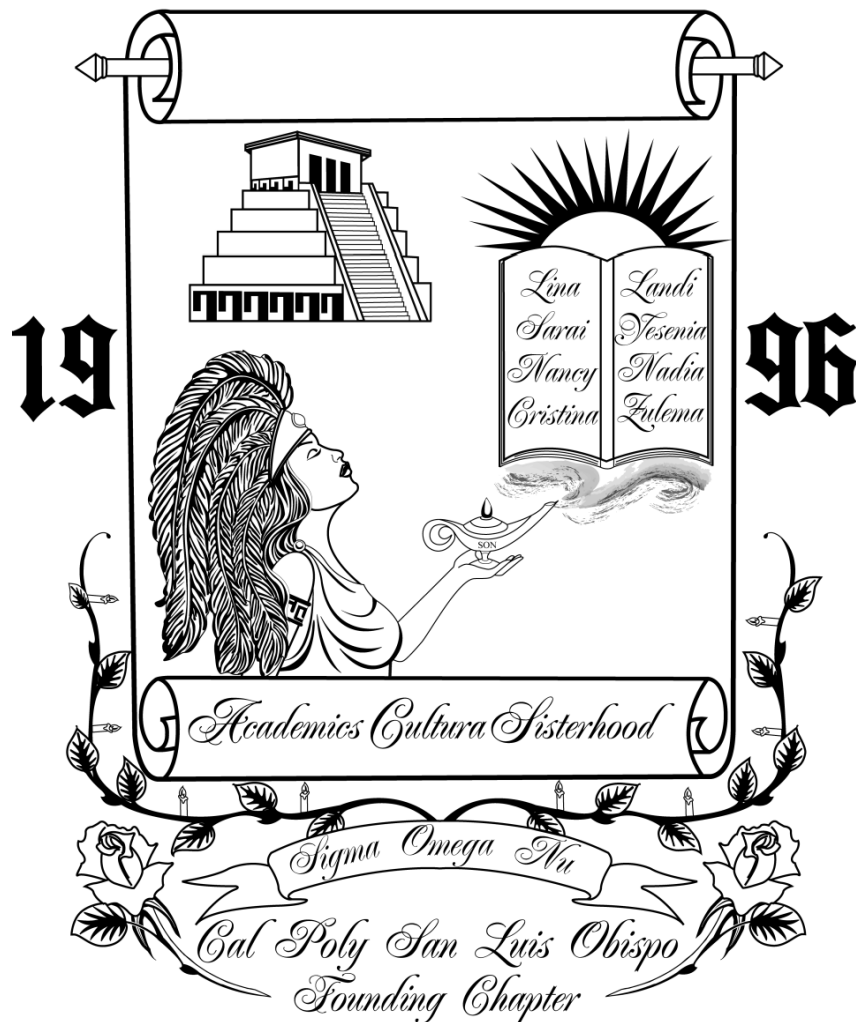


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Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc.



National Bylaws

National Bylaws

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Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. National Bylaws

Article I. Preamble

Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. established its National Board as a way of uniting all of its Chapters under one official board. This organization shall be a non-profit public benefit organization.

Article II. Mission Statement

Sigma Omega Nu is an organization that is built on academics, cultura, and sisterhood. Sigma Omega Nu provides a support system, cultura awareness, and a long-live sisterhood. It is a comfort zone where respect, accountability, and compassion are given and learned for womxn and the community.

Article III. Vision Statement

Sigma Omega Nu, Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. offers a unique sisterly experience for empowering womxn, by creating scholastic excellence, bringing cultura awareness, and providing a sisterhood bond in higher education.

Article IV. Purpose

The purpose of the National Board shall be to act as the guiding board for Sigma Omega Nu Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. The National Board shall provide leadership and guidance for all Sigma Omega Nu members and Chapters to successfully strive for scholastic excellence, Latina/o cultural awareness, sisterhood, community service, self-improvement and professional development. The National Board shall provide general guidance to members and Chapters for their continual progress and advancement. The National Board may act as a mediator between Chapters in order to provide solutions for conflicts or disputes. The National Board shall also be responsible for overseeing all aspects of the Expansion Process.

Article V. Identification

Section A. Organization Identification

The official name of this sorority is Sigma Omega Nu, Latina Interest Sorority, Inc. This name may be used interchangeably with Sigma Omega Nu or the Greek ΣΩΝ. The name Sigma Omega Nu shall be used in the remainder of this document. The informal nicknames of “SON” and “Sunnies” may also be used to identify the Sorority however these nicknames may only be used for informal identification purposes only.

Section B. Definitions

The following definitions shall also be used in the remainder of this document:

1. National Board Officers: Those members of the Executive Cabinet and the National Directors.
2. National Board Members: Those members currently holding National Office as identified in Article V. below. This includes the Executive Cabinet, the National Directors, and the Members at Large.
3. National Board: The collective term used to refer to the National Board Officers and National Board

Members.

4. Chapters: The collective term used to refer to Sigma Omega Nu's Undergraduate and Alumnae Chapters.
5. Active Members: Those members currently enrolled at a University where an Undergraduate Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu exists and who currently hold Active Status at their respective Chapter.
6. Inactive Members: Those members currently enrolled at a University where an Undergraduate Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu exists and who currently hold Inactive Status at their respective Chapter.
7. Alumnae Members: The collective term used to refer to those members who have graduated from an accredited University.
8. Chapter Active Alumnae: Those Alumnae Members who hold Active Status at an Undergraduate Chapter.
9. National Active Alumnae: Those Alumnae Members who hold Active Status with the organization at a National level and not at an Undergraduate Chapter.
10. General Members: Those members who do not otherwise meet the definition of Active, Inactive, or Alumnae Members
11. Sigma Omega Nu Members: The collective term used to refer to any and all members of Sigma Omega Nu, regardless of status or office held.
12. Good Standing: The term used to indicate that an individual Sister or an entire Chapter is fulfilling their duties and responsibilities, regardless of status. See Article VI. Membership for duties and responsibilities required of individual Sisters
13. Probation: The disciplinary status assigned to an individual Sister or an entire Chapter as a result of failure to perform their duties and/or fulfill their responsibilities.
14. Suspension: The disciplinary status assigned to an individual Sister or an entire Chapter as a result of failure to perform their duties and/or fulfill their responsibilities. Suspension is a more severe status than Probation. See Article XVI. Suspension in these Chapter Bylaws and Article XVI. Chapters in the National Board Bylaws for additional information.
15. Deactivation: The process through which a Sister is no longer recognized as a member of Sigma Omega Nu. This may be voluntarily requested by the Sister, or may be imposed by the Sorority as a disciplinary sanction following a Judicial Review.
16. Simple Majority: During a meeting in which a quorum is present, a simple majority vote means 51% of those eligible to vote.
17. Plurality of Votes: In an election, the candidate that receives the most votes, even if not the majority.

Article VI. Membership

National Board membership is open to all Sigma Omega Nu Active Members and Alumnae Members, so long as they meet the qualifications for the individual officer position.

There will be no discrimination on the basis of initiating chapter, cultural identify, religion, creed, sexual preference, political affiliation, assigned sex, or disabilities.

Section A. Eligibility

1. All members must hold a clear account balance with all Chapters and the National Board prior to being nominated.
2. The officers of the Executive Cabinet and Regional Directors shall hold a minimum of a Bachelor's degree from an accredited four-year university AND have been a Sister of Sigma Omega Nu for a minimum of three years.
3. All Directors must have a minimum of one year's membership as a Sister of Sigma Omega Nu.
4. Members at Large must meet the eligibility requirements identified in Article VII. National Officers, if any.

Section B. Active Members

1. Although not encouraged, Chapter Active Members may hold National office. To be eligible, Active Members must maintain a minimum quarterly/semester grade point average (GPA) of 2.3 and a minimum cumulative grade point average (GPA) of 2.5, and must remain Active at their respective Chapter for the full duration of their term on National Board. Failure to maintain such requirements shall result in removal from any/all National Board position(s).
2. An Active Member may not hold National office for the following reasons:
 - a. Participation in an Inter/national Study Abroad or Co-operative Program at her respective University.
 - b. Holding Inactive, Probation, or Suspended status at any Undergraduate Chapter.
 - c. Failure to maintain the minimum GPA requirements.

Section C. Multiple Memberships

Members of Sigma Omega Nu may join other Greek lettered organizations, so long as their membership meets the following requirements:

1. Honorary Membership
Any member of this Sorority may join an honorary club or fraternity, or hold an honorary title. Membership or entitlement is given in recognition of the Sister's excellence in their course of study or contributions to the University. Membership is by invitation only.
2. Professional Membership
Any member of this Sorority may join a professional, service or leadership-based co-ed fraternity. These organizations are founded on career development, community service or leadership development. They do not prohibit members of social fraternities or sororities from membership.
3. Prohibition
No member of this Sorority may be a member of any other socially or culturally based sorority or fraternity. Any member wishing to join one of these organizations must first complete Sigma Omega Nu's deactivation process prior to seeking membership. Any woman interested in joining Sigma Omega Nu must provide proof of having completed the deactivation of any previous organization(s) prior to beginning the Sigma Omega Nu membership process.

Article VII. National Officers

Section A. National Executive Cabinet

The National Executive Cabinet shall be responsible for the general oversight of the Sorority. The National Executive Cabinet shall consist of the following nine officers: National President; National Vice President; National Vice President of Parliament; National Vice President of Communications; National Vice President of Finance; National Vice President of Risk Management; National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs; National Vice President of Alumnae Affairs; National Vice President of Programming.

1. National President Shall:

- Be a member of the National Board for a minimum of two years prior to her election.
- Preside over all National Board meetings, activities, and functions.
- Provide general supervision of the National Board, Chapters, and members of Sigma Omega Nu.
- Have the power to delegate new projects as necessary.
- Have the power to call emergency meetings with at least 48 hours' notice to all National Board members.
- Designate events at official National ΣΩΝ activities with at least three months' advance notice to membership.
- Preside over and facilitate the officer transition meeting(s) at the conclusion of their term.

- Supervise and support National Board members in the execution of their duties.
- Assign an acting secretary in the absence of the National Vice President of Communications
- Recognize National Board members and officers for outstanding involvement with the National Board and with national activities.
- Ensure continuity of operations during officer absences.
- Hold President Roundtables with Chapter Presidents at least twice quarterly within the academic year.
- Assist the Director of Expansion with the planning, organizing, and coordinating of all Prospective Chapter Post-Pledgeship workshop(s) for any newly established Chapter(s).
- Along with the National Vice President, meet with the Executive Board of newly established Chapters at least once annually for the first three years following establishment.
- Confirm the date, time, and location of National Board meetings and activities.
- Serve as the official liaison between the National Board and the Alumnae Advisory Committee.
- Serve as the primary point of contact between Sigma Omega Nu and NALFO (or other national umbrella councils)
- Oversee the annual renewal of Sigma Omega Nu's General Liability and Accident Prevention insurance policies, and provide copies of the certificate of insurance to each Chapter and/or the appropriate university Greek advisor.
- Have the authority to make monetary transactions in the absence of the National Vice President of Finance, so long as the National Vice President of Finance has authorized her to do so.

2. National Vice President Shall:

- Perform the duties of the National President in their absence.
- Call an emergency meeting with the President's approval and notify all National Board members at least 48 hours in advance.
- Maintain Sigma Omega Nu's current governing documents (Articles of Incorporation, Bylaws, Standing Rules, Traditions, Code of Ethics, Policies/Procedures) and approved proposals.
- Oversee and execute the governing document amendment process, as outlined in Article I. of the National Standing Rules.
- Maintain a comprehensive log tracking all proposed amendments, including who wrote the proposal, when the proposal was distributed to National Board Officers and Chapters, when the proposal was discussed, when the proposal was voted on, and whether the proposal was passed or rejected.
- Conduct periodic assessments of Sigma Omega Nu's governing documents to ensure continued relevance, legal compliance, and organizational effectiveness.
- Develop and submit formal proposals to the National Board recommending updates, structural improvements, or policy revisions necessary to maintain the sorority's growth and sustainability.
- Along with the National President, meet with the Executive Board of newly established Chapters at least once annually for the first three years following establishment.

3. National Vice President of Parliament Shall:

- Preserve order at all National Board meetings.
- Ensure officers follow the agenda closely and keep issues in focus
- Keep each agenda topic in discussion for no more than 20 minutes
- Keep National Board and National Council meetings to a maximum of three hours until a motion to extend the meeting has been approved by a simple majority vote
- Keep a record of absences, tardiness, and letters of excuse, and have these available at all meetings
- Enforce all penalties and fines and report them no more than two (2) days after such occurrence

to the National Vice President of Finance

- Run the annual National Board elections
- Reserve the right to give pop quizzes, at any time, regarding pertinent information about this organization
- Be responsible for testing elected Chapter Representatives prior to each representative taking office.
- Be responsible for testing members of this Sorority in order to determine if such a member(s) may participate in Prospective Chapter Pledge Class activities.

4. National Vice President of Communications Shall:

- Be responsible for preparing all meeting agendas and taking minutes at all meetings.
- Distribute the agenda for the current meeting and the minutes from the previous meeting at least forty-eight (48) hours prior to any scheduled National Board or National Council meeting
- Distribute minutes from National Board or National Council meetings within 7 days after the meeting.
- Maintain an accurate record of the minutes from previous meetings and keep all records accessible
- Be responsible for regularly checking the national/general email account.
- Keep a file with the National Board correspondence
- Be responsible for the compilation and upkeep of current National and Chapter rosters
- Be responsible for the printing and distribution of National Board election ballots
- Be responsible for the purchase and presentation of all birthday cards
- Maintain a current master calendar of all Sigma Omega Nu Chapter and National activities and events
- Ensure all calendar information is available to all members in an online/digital format
- Directly oversee the National Director of Branding & Publicity.

5. National Vice President of Finance Shall:

- Have the authority to make monetary transactions on behalf of the National Board using the National Board account in accordance with the vote approved by the National Board.
- Receive, collect, safeguard, and disburse all National Board funds, and maintain accurate, current, and complete financial records for all National Board accounts and transactions.
- Maintain the National Board financial books in an accurate and up to date manner, make them available for review by the National Board upon request, and submit them to the National President upon request and no later than January 1st of each year.
- Provide regular financial reports to the National Board, including: the status of all National Board financial accounts at each National Board meeting or upon request; and a financial statement summarizing National Board income and expenses.
- Immediately notify the National President of any lost, missing, or suspected misappropriated funds and report such matters to the National Board at its next meeting.
- Review all tentative and final budgets, requests for funds, reimbursements, and other financial request submitted to the National Board for accuracy, completeness, and compliance with the National Board policies, and make recommendations for action.
- Process reimbursements only for purchases that were previously approved by the National Board and supported by appropriate receipts submitted within four weeks of the purchase, unless otherwise approved by the National Board.
- Maintain current financial account records for all National Board Members and Chapters and provide updated account statements: to National Board Members at each National Board meeting or upon request; and to Chapters at each National Council meeting or upon request.

- Establish, administer, and enforce Financial Contracts approved by the National Board for Members and Chapters.
- Provide financial guidance and support to Chapters and Chapter Treasurers regarding financial policies, recurring and annual obligations, recordkeeping, and fiscal management.
- Plan, organize, and coordinate a finance workshop at the Annual Conference covering the duties, responsibilities, and best practices for Chapter Treasurers.
- Monitor the organization's credit report at least once per calendar year and report any significant findings to the National Board.
- Conduct financial audits of each Chapter's financial book at least once per academic year, with or without prior notice, and provide the National Board with a summary of audit findings and recommendations for corrective action.
- Collect the financial books of the National Board and all Chapters by January 1st of each year, complete the annual financial review by January 30th, provide guidance regarding any required corrections prior to tax preparation, and establish deadlines for the submission of corrected records.
- Serve as the primary liaison with any accountants, auditors, or tax preparers engaged by the organization, and ensure all required tax returns and governmental financial filings are accurate and submitted in a timely manner.
- Directly oversee the Director of Fundraising.

6. National Vice President of Risk Management Shall:

- Be knowledgeable about and enforce all University policies, with specific attention to the following policies: Alcohol & Drug, Hazing, Title IX, and Discrimination.
- Be knowledgeable about and enforce all Sigma Omega Nu policies, with specific attention to the following policies: Alcohol & Drug, Hazing, Risk Management, Sexual Misconduct, and Discrimination.
- Collect third party alcohol provider verifications and keep on file.
- Prior to each National event, assess potential risks and identify mitigations in accordance with University and Sorority policies to ensure members' well-being and safety.
- Complete and keep on file a risk assessment checklist for each national event. Risk assessment checklist will include potential risks, potential mitigations, and potential impacts.
- Required to coordinate a risk management presentation at minimum at the National Conference.
- Required to provide training to Risk Management Officers each academic term.
- Schedule and lead all Risk Management Committee meetings as needed.
- Serve as the point of contact on all risk management issues and update the National Board as appropriate.
- Alongside the National President, be responsible for handling all risk management issues and filling out any applicable incident/accident reports (when necessary) to the University and the insurance provider.
- Alongside the National President, act as a point of contact with the Insurance provider.
- Manage and track the incident reports submitted to the National Board, and write and present a judicial review letter to the National Board for approval.

7. National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs Shall:

- Provide current Chapter Reports to the National Vice President of Communications prior to each National Board meeting.
- Oversee the Chapter Standards Program, including the collection of all Chapter Standards electronic binders, coordination of grading assignments among National Board members, and

compilation of composite scores and feedback sheets.

- Collaborate with the appropriate Regional Director on an Improvement Plan for Chapters that receive a Chapter Standards ranking of Probation or Suspension.
- Ensure all Regional Directors and Undergraduate Chapters are aware of deadlines set by the National Board within one week of the deadline being established.
- Ensure all Regional Directors and Undergraduate Chapters are aware of important updates from National Board on National ΣΩΝ events, policy, etc.
- Provide the Undergraduate Chapters with guidance on Chapter matters, when necessary or requested.
- Inform the Regional Directors when new or updated governing documents or other forms are available for the Chapters' use.
- Assist the Director of Expansion with the Post Prospective Chapter Workshops for newly established Chapters.
- Have on file a copy of all quarter/semester grades for each member currently enrolled at a University where a Chapter exists.
- Maintain a file listing all S.O.N Member Scholarship recipients and provide each recipient with a certificate.
- Directly oversee the Director of Expansion and the Regional Directors.

8. National Vice President of Alumnae Affairs Shall:

- Maintain accurate database of all Alumnae of this Sorority
- Inform alumnae of important upcoming National events and the National Board meetings
- Coordinate a minimum of one National alumnae event per academic school year
- Provide the National Vice President of Communications with updated alumnae information each time such information is obtained
- Compose and/or up-keep an Alumnae Resume book
- Organize an alumnae track for the National Conference of workshops and guest speakers that focus on professional development and career development
- Assist the Founding Chapter with planning all milestone anniversary celebrations
- Oversee all Sigma Omega Nu Alumnae Chapters
- Accept, review, and process Graduation Declarations, when received
- Provide guidance to the Chapter Commissioners of Alumnae Relations as appropriate.

9. National Vice President of Programming Shall:

- Plan, coordinate, and execute the four official National Sigma Omega Nu events annually (National Conference, Executive Retreat, Sunnie Summit, and Battle of the Chapters), establishing goals and programming objectives consistent with the organization's mission and strategic priorities.
- Develop and maintain event planning timelines, benchmarks, and operational standards to ensure successful implementation.
- Appoint and oversee planning committees for each national event; delegate responsibilities as appropriate; conduct regular progress check-ins; and ensure all assigned tasks are completed in accordance with established deadlines and national expectations.
- Oversee and support the Chapter selected to host a national event and serve as the primary liaison between the National Board and the host Chapter for all event-related matters.
- Develop and distribute official bid materials and establish procedures for Chapters seeking to host national events (National Conference and Executive Retreat); review submitted bids for feasibility, and preparedness.

- Research and evaluate potential locations and venues for National Conference and Executive Retreat, including cost analysis and logistical considerations, and present formal recommendations for host Chapters and event locations to the National Board.
- Develop tentative and final event budgets in collaboration with the host Chapter and submit all proposed budgets to the National Vice President of Finance for review and approval prior to the incurrence of expenses.
- Monitor event expenditures to ensure adherence to the approved budget and collect and submit all receipts and the final budget to the National Vice President of Finance in a timely manner.
- Coordinate workshops, speakers, and educational programming for National Conference, Executive Retreat, and Sunnie Summit, collaborating with the National Vice President of Alumnae Affairs to incorporate alumnae-led professional development programming as appropriate.
- Administer post-event evaluations and present a written report to the National Board following each national event, including attendance, program outcomes, financial overview (in coordination with the National Vice President of Finance), and recommendations for improvement.
- Maintain a National Event Planning Manual to ensure continuity, institutional knowledge, and consistency in national programming efforts.

Section B. National Directors

The Directors of Sigma Omega Nu are responsible for additional work and coordination required to fulfill the direction set forth by the Executive Cabinet. The following are considered the National Directors of Sigma Omega Nu: National Director of Branding & Publicity; National Director of Fundraising; National Director of Expansion; Regional Directors; and National Director of Service.

1. National Director of Branding & Publicity Shall:

- Be responsible for maintaining Sigma Omega Nu's digital Crest
- Be responsible for maintaining and updating Sigma Omega Nu's National Branding Guidelines
- Design National marketing content for the Sorority for use across platforms, including but not limited to, content promoting recruitment and expansion efforts; fundraisers; community service; academic and professional achievements; and other announcements.
- Maintain the Sigma Omega Nu National website
- Work with National Social Media Manager to design and publish a quarterly National Newsletter
- Seek the advice of a professional web designer if necessary
- Provide guidance to the Chapter Commissioners of Public Relations as appropriate

2. National Director of Fundraising Shall:

- Be responsible for ordering and keeping a supply of all Official Sorority paraphernalia
- Seek avenues of fundraising for the National Board
- Fundraise for the S.O.N. Member Scholarship
- Plan, organize, and coordinate at least two fundraisers per academic year in which all proceeds will be given to the National Board
- Provide guidance to the Chapter Commissioners of Fundraising as appropriate

3. National Director of Expansion Shall:

- Oversee all expansion efforts in accordance with the Undergraduate Expansion Process and the Standardized Prospective Chapter Pledgeship.
- Respond in a timely manner to any group of women who have expressed interest in establishing a chapter of this organization
- Have on file an updated version of the Expansion Process for establishing a chapter of this organization

- Be responsible for maintaining and updating all standard forms, documents, and presentations related to the expansion process
- Plan, organize, and coordinate all expansion informational sessions
- Be responsible for attaining all relevant information with regards to the rules and regulations pertaining to expansion to an accredited University
- Keep an accurate and updated calendar of events of the interest groups, and provide this calendar to the National Vice President of Communications
- Meet with the advisor(s) of an interested group and/or Prospective Chapter pledge classes
- Maintain and update all materials that are contained in the New Chapter Binder
- Inform the appropriate Greek council of a new Chapter's establishment within 48 hours, or as appropriate
- Plan, organize, and facilitate all Post-Prospective Chapter Workshops within one month after Crossover and the establishment of the Chapter.
- Lead monthly Progress Check-ins with each Prospective Chapter, along with the appropriate Regional Director

4. Regional Directors Shall:

- Represent the interest of the Chapters at all National Board meetings and events.
- Be responsible for maintaining an updated calendar of events hosted by each Chapter, and provide this information to the National Vice President of Communications.
- Be the direct link between the Undergraduate Chapters and the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs.
- Provide the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs with a Chapter Report of the Undergraduate Chapters within her region on a monthly basis.
- Help the Undergraduate Chapters with interpretation rulings of the Bylaws, Standing Rules, Pledgeship Standardization, Policies, and any other governing documents.
- Within 24 hours of receiving, provide initial review of all documents required to be submitted by Chapters prior to being authorized to deliver bids or to proceed with Crossover, and submit completed documents to the National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs on behalf of each Chapter. See Chapter Pledgeship, Article VIII Bids & Pinning, Section A. Administration, and Article XVII Crossover, Section A. Administration, for more information.
- Conduct a minimum of one unannounced audit of the pledgeship process for each pledge class of each Undergraduate Chapter within her region, either in person or via electronic submittal.
- Provide guidance and assistance to the Undergraduate Chapters within her region on their Chapter Standards report, when requested.
- Hold a quarterly meeting with the Presidents of the Undergraduate Chapters in her region to discuss issues affecting those Chapters, date, time, and location/networking medium to be determined by Regional Director.
- Ensure all Undergraduate Chapters are aware of deadlines set by the National Board within one week of the deadline being established.
- Ensure all Undergraduate Chapters within her region are aware of important updates from National Board on National ΣΩΝ events, policy, etc.
- Inform the President of any Alumnae Chapters within her region of the Undergraduate Chapters' upcoming events.
- Participate in monthly Progress Check-ins with each Colony, along in coordination with the Director of Expansion

5. National Director of Service Shall:

- Maintain an updated record of the chosen philanthropies of each Chapter.
- Review and evaluate Chapter requests to change or adopt new philanthropies and present

recommendations to the National Board for approval.

- Provide guidance and resources to Chapter Commissioners of Community Service to promote effective community service programming.
- Promote consistency and accountability in Chapter community service participation, including collecting and maintaining records of hours per member and per Chapter.
- Compile and present an annual National Service Impact Report to the National Board summarizing service hours, participation rates, and philanthropic impact.
- Organize and coordinate a community service project for all New Members during Sunnie Summit weekend, in collaboration with the National Vice President of Programming.
- Serve as the official liaison between Sigma Omega Nu and NALFO regarding National Day of Service communication and programming.
- Disseminate all National Day of Service information and requirements received from NALFO to Regional Directors and Undergraduate Chapters in a timely manner.
- At minimum, coordinate an event for Sigma Omega Nu's participation in NALFO's National Day of Service and notify Chapters of any mandatory involvement.

Section C. Members at Large

The following are considered Members at Large of the Sigma Omega Nu National Board: National Social Media Manager; National Archivist; the Colony Directors; and the Chapter Representatives.

1. National Social Media Manager Shall:

- Report directly to the National Director of Branding and Publicity
- Maintain the Sigma Omega Nu National social media accounts with up-to-date and accurate information, in accordance with the National Branding Guidelines
- Monitor social media content distributed by Chapters to ensure it is in alignment with to the organization's mission and objectives
- Work with National Director of Publicity to design and publish a quarterly National Newsletter
- Monitor trending and up-and-coming social media platforms, and propose to the National Board if an account on a new platform should be created
- Review and approve all Recruitment and Pledgeship publicity materials, both print and digital, within 1 week of receiving from Chapters, or identify revisions or corrections needed within that same timeframe.

2. National Archivist Shall:

- Report directly to the National Vice President of Programming.
- Create and/or maintain an accurate history of all National Board activities in the form of scrapbook(s), photo albums and/or slides
- Take pictures at every National event unless specifically asked not to
- Maintain an updated profile of each Sigma Omega Nu Chapter, including the Chapter's History
- Duplicate photos and other materials as needed by the National Board
- Provide the National Website Manager photos and other media for the National Website
- Keep a master list of all the property belonging to all Sigma Omega Nu Chapters and/or the National Board.
- Maintain a check out system for official Sigma Omega Nu property owned by the National Board
- Provide guidance to the Chapter Historians as appropriate.

3. Colony Director(s) Shall:

- Report directly to the National Director of Expansion.
- Follow the most recent version of the Undergraduate Expansion Process and the Standardized Colony Pledgeship

- Submit a tentative budget itemizing all Prospective Chapter expenses prior to Pinning
- Develop a Pledgeship Calendar of Events in collaboration with the Director of Expansion, for approval in accordance with the Standardized Prospective Chapter Pledgeship
- Attain all material(s) required throughout the duration of the Prospective Chapter Pledgeship process
- Hold regular meetings with the Prospective Chapter as required by Standardized Prospective Chapter Pledgeship
- Provide monthly updates to the Prospective Chapter Schedule the Pledge Committee and Director of Expansion
- Notify the National Board, Chapters, and other members of their attendance obligations for each Prospective Chapter, in accordance with the Undergraduate Expansion Process.

4. Chapter Representatives Shall:

- Report directly to the Chapter's designated Regional Director.
- Be the liaison between her respective Chapter and the National Board
- Represent her Chapter at all National Council meetings and/or all National Board activities when necessary and required by the National Board
- Inform her respective Chapter and her Chapter's Commissioner of Social Affairs of all upcoming National Board meetings and/or national activities
- Inform her respective Chapter of all material requested of the Chapter by the National Board, and is responsible for submitting those materials when requested
- Represent the Chapter at all National ΣΩΝ events, and at any National Board events where her presence is required.
- Be the point of contact between her Chapter and the hosting Chapter of any National ΣΩΝ events.
- Provide the Regional Director with accurate Chapter Reports on a monthly basis.
- Provide updated Chapter Roster to the National Vice President of Communications as required, or as requested.
- Be responsible for ensuring all dues, fines, and other payments be submitted to the National Vice President of Finance.
- Be the point of contact to the Director of Social Affairs for all National ΣΩΝ events or any National Board events where the presence of the Chapter is required.
- Ensure her Chapter's Commissioner of Alumnae Affairs is regularly informing Chapter alumnae of National ΣΩΝ events or new policy that may be of interest to alumnae.

Article VIII. Responsibilities & Duties

Section A. Responsibilities

Minimum responsibilities for National Board Members shall be to:

1. Fulfill all responsibilities as identified in Article VII. National Officers, above, as well as any other requirements identified in additional governing documents or policies relevant to the specific office.
2. Act in the best interest of Sigma Omega Nu as a whole. With the exception of the Chapter Representatives, no Member of National Board shall act in the interest of any Chapter.
3. Attend all National meetings required for their position, as identified in Section C., below.
4. Pay all incurred fees and fines
5. Maintain an account balance of zero with both her initiating Chapter and the National Board
6. Participate in the execution of the annual Sigma Omega Nu National Conference, as directed by the National Vice President of Programming.

Section B. Relief from Obligations

Under extreme and rare cases, a National Board member may be relieved from obligations for a period of time for the following reasons:

1. Extreme financial difficulties
2. Extreme health conditions
3. Death within her immediate family

A letter must be submitted to the National Board Sergeant at Arms explaining her circumstances and identifying a set amount of time she is requesting to be relieved of obligations. The letter must be passed by a majority vote by the members of the Executive Cabinet.

Section C. Attendance

1. Executive Cabinet

The members of the Executive Cabinet are required to attend all Executive Cabinet meetings, National Board meetings, and National Council meetings.

2. National Directors

The National Directors are required to attend all National Board meetings, and National Council meetings.

3. Members at Large

The Members at Large, including Chapter Representatives, are required to attend all National Council meetings.

4. National ΣΩΝ Events

A minimum of two (2) officers of National Board shall be required to attend each National ΣΩΝ event. In the event a Prospective Chapter is required to attend a National ΣΩΝ event, a minimum of 80% of the members of National Board are also required to attend.

5. Prospective Chapter Events

See the Undergraduate Expansion Process for attendance requirements related to Prospective Chapter events and activities.

Section D. Voting

National Board Officers shall not have greater voting power than any other member. National Board Officers shall be of open mind and character, taking all points of view into consideration. All National Board Members shall perform any other duties required by their office. Only National Board Members shall be able to vote at the National Board meetings. Any member of Sigma Omega Nu may attend meetings however they shall not have any voting power. At no time shall there be voting by proxy.

Section E. Letter of Excuse

National Board Members may be excused from a National Board meeting or activity if a letter or e-mail is presented to the National Vice President of Parliamentary Procedure at least one week prior to any National Board meeting or activity. The letter must be passed by the National Board no later than the National Board meeting following the missed meeting or activity. Only under special circumstances such as emergency meetings and/or last minute activities shall a letter or e-mail be accepted no less than 24-hours prior to a meeting or activity. Events or meetings with less than one week advance notice will not be considered mandatory.

Section F. Transition

A transition meeting must be held between the outgoing Officer and the incoming Officer. This meeting must be held after elections, but before August 1. All official documents, records, and binders specific to the position must be given to the incoming Officer no later than the annual National Conference.

Section G. Suspension

1. National Board Members may be suspended with her privileges withdrawn at any time by a 3/4th vote of all National Board officers at any given National Board meeting for any of the following reasons:

- a. For violation of the Bylaws, Standing Rules, or Code of Ethics
 - b. For refusal to pay any debts and/or fines to the National Board and/or to any Sigma Omega Nu Chapter(s)
 - c. For suspension from her respective University due to inappropriate disciplinary action
2. Any member of Sigma Omega Nu under suspension shall not participate in any National Board functions, National events, nor use/wear the name, insignia, or paraphernalia of Sigma Omega Nu in any way or at any time.

Article IX. Elections

Section A. Nominations

1. Qualifications
Members wishing to be nominated for an office must have a clear member account with any Chapter previously affiliated with, and with the National Board. The member does not need to be present at the time of nomination. Nominations will be accepted in the format identified by the National Board.
2. Nomination
Any position eligible for election for the upcoming term will be announced to the Sorority no later than May 25 of each year. The date and time of elections will also be announced at that time. Nominations for eligible positions will open on June 1 of each year, and will close at 11:59pm Pacific Time on June 20. Nominations will not be accepted after that time. The National Vice President of Parliament will notify all nominees of their nomination within 48 hours after nominations have closed. If a nominee wishes to accept her nomination, she must submit a resume of her qualifications to the National Vice President of
3. Communications no later than June 30. Any nominee not providing a resume by June 30 will be automatically removed from the ballot.
 - a. Resumes of nominees for positions other than Regional Directors must be sent to the National Board Officers no later than July 5.
 - b. Resumes of nominees for Regional Directors must be sent to the Chapters within each Region no later than July 15.
4. Prospective Chapter Directors
Nominations for Prospective Chapter Directors will open one month prior to the date of election, as identified in the Strategic Plan prepared by the Director of Expansion. Nominations will close two weeks prior to the date of election. If a nominee wishes to accept her nomination, she must submit a resume of her qualifications to the National Vice President of Communications by the same deadline. Any nominee not providing a resume by this deadline will be automatically removed from the ballot.
 - a. Resumes of nominees must be sent to the National Board Officers within one week after the closing of nominations.

Section B. Elections

1. Requirements
Elections for all positions (other than Regional Directors and Prospective Chapter Directors) must be conducted no later than July 20 of each year. It is at the discretion of the existing National Board Officers to determine if elections are to be held in-person or virtually. Nominees must be present and available on the date of elections as identified by the National Board. If a nominee is not present, their name will automatically be removed from the ballot..
2. Election
Before voting commences, nominees must give a speech addressing their plans, goals, etc. for their nominated position(s). The National Board Officers will be given the opportunity to ask questions of each candidate. Elections will occur by secret ballot. The National Vice President of Communications is responsible for providing printed ballots. An electronic ballot can be used if agreed upon by the

National Board Officers. An option of “No Confidence” shall be listed for all positions, regardless of the number of nominees. Unless otherwise specified, only one name under each position shall be selected. After the National Board Officers have completed their ballot, the National Vice President of Parliament will collect all the ballots. The National President and National Vice President of Parliament will count the votes for each position. If voting is done by electronic ballot, the National President and National Vice President of Parliament will ensure that all ballots have been cast. A plurality of votes is needed for a nominated member to win office. After the votes have been counted, and each new officer is identified, the current President will announce the new officers for the following term.

- a. In case of a tie, the National Vice President of Parliament will repeat the election process and the vote shall be between the tied members only.
 - b. In the event of a single nominee for any given office, a speech must still be presented, and voting shall take place as usual. If a majority vote of “no confidence” is received, nominations and elections shall begin again following the announcement of the other offices.
3. Regional Directors
The Regional Directors shall be elected at the annual National Convention. The procedure for election will be the same as the procedure for other Officers, identified above. Each Regional Director shall be elected only by the Chapters that are within her Region. The Regional Directors will take office immediately after election.
4. Prospective Chapter Directors
Elections for Prospective Chapter Directors shall be held at the National Board meeting identified in the Strategic Plan prepared by the Director of Expansion. The procedure for election will be the same as the procedure for other Officers, identified above.

Section C. Term

1. Executive Cabinet Officers
Executive Cabinet officers shall be elected for a two-year term, beginning on August 1 and ending on July 31 two years later.
2. Regional Directors
Regional Directors shall be elected for a two-year term, beginning in August and ending in July two years later.
3. Directors and Members at Large
Directors and Members at Large shall be elected for a one-year term, beginning in August and ending in July of the following year.
4. Prospective Chapter Directors
Prospective Chapter Directors will serve only for the duration of the Prospective Chapter Process for which they are elected.

Section D. Installation

Newly elected National Board Officers officially take office on August 1, but will be presented to the Sorority during the annual National Convention. The new Officers will run the National Council meeting held during National Convention. Regional Directors and Prospective Chapter Directors shall take office immediately after election. National Chapter Representatives shall serve for a term as required by the Chapter Bylaws.

Section E. Term Limits

All National Board Members are eligible for re-election. Executive Cabinet and Regional Directors cannot hold the office for more than two consecutive terms. National Directors and Members at Large cannot hold the office for more than four consecutive terms.

Article X. Vacancies and Resignations

Section A. Vacant Office

Should a vacancy exist, it shall be filled promptly by nomination and election, following the same rules for the standard election of officers. If the office remains vacant for more than 4 months after elections are held, the National President may appoint someone to that position. However, the appointee must meet the qualifications for that position and provide a resume of qualifications to the National Board Officers within 48 hours of being appointed. The appointee will take office only after the resume has been reviewed and the appointee has received a majority vote by the National Board Officers. When a vacancy is filled by appointment, the remainder of the term being filled shall not be counted towards the term limit identified in Article IX., Section E. Term Limits.

Section B. Resignation

Resignation from office shall be accepted for emergency cases. Any National Board Officer vacating her position after she has accepted the responsibility to take an office shall be required to present her case for doing so to the National Board. After hearing her case, the National Board will deliberate and vote first to approve the resignation, and second on whether she shall be penalized for vacating her office. A simple majority vote is needed for both. If the National Board finds that her resignation is not for an emergency reason as identified in Article VIII Responsibilities & Duties, Section B Relief from Obligations, she shall be prohibited from holding any office within the National Board for a period of one year, effective immediately.

Section C. Removal from Office

All National Board Officers are limited to no more than one unexcused meeting absence per term year (August through July). If an Officer has a second unexcused meeting absence within the term year, she will be removed from office, effective as of the date of the second missed meeting. The position will be considered vacant immediately following the meeting and may be filled by appointment, as described in Section A above.

Article XI. Removal from Office

Section A. Removal

Any National Board Member may be removed from office for the following reasons:

1. More than one unexcused meeting absence per term year.
2. As a sanction resulting from a formal Judicial Review if the results of the Judicial Review demonstrated that the Officer significantly failed to fulfill the duties and responsibilities of their office.

If an Officer is removed from National office due to unexcused absences, the removal alone will not affect their member status or standing.

A member who was removed from office may not fill any other vacant office by appointment, but may be nominated during the next election cycle.

Section B. Appeal

Any member who has been removed from office as a consequence of a formal Judicial Review may appeal the decision to the National Board through the Judicial Review appeal process.

Article XII. Dues and Fines

Section A. Administration of Funds

Funds shall be administered through the National Vice President of Finance. In the event the National Vice President of Finance is unable to administer funds, the National President may act on her behalf.

Section B. Member Account Balance Statement

The National Vice President of Finance will provide a copy of their current account balance statement for each National Board Officer at every National Board Meeting, for each Chapter at every National Council Meeting, and for all that owe a balance at least two weeks prior to any payment deadlines established. Late fees shall be imposed upon all unpaid dues and fines.

Section C. Dues

Dues are required to be paid by all members actively participating in a Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu. A portion of these dues is owed to the National Board in order to fund National events, activities, and programming. The National Board is permitted to use these funds as they see fit, so long as it is used for the exclusive betterment of the Sorority.

1. Chapter Dues

All Sigma Omega Nu Chapters shall be responsible for paying dues to the National Board. The amount owed to National Board is \$75 per Chapter Member that holds Active or Inactive Status. This amount is due by October 15 of each year, along with the Membership Dues form.

2. New Member Dues

When New Members are initiated into a Chapter, New Member Dues are owed to the National Board in the amount of \$75 per New Member. This amount is due within two weeks after Crossover, along with the New Member Initiation Form. This requirement also applies to Prospective Chapters and the establishment of new Chapters

3. National Alumnae Dues

Alumnae who desire to maintain Active Status with the Sorority but not at an Undergraduate Chapter may obtain National Active Alumna status with the National Board. National Alumnae Dues are available in the following tiers: Black Level (\$50); Burgundy Level (\$75); and Gold Level (\$100). See the National Board Standing Rules for more information.

4. Pledgeship Dues

All Little Sisters are required to pay a non-refundable fee before beginning the Sigma Omega Nu Pledgeship Process. This applies to both Chapter Pledgeship and Prospective Chapter Pledgeship. The amount of Pledgeship Dues is to be determined by each Chapter, or in the case of a Prospective Chapter by the Prospective Chapter Directors.

Section D. Fines & Late Fees

1. Officers and Chapters will be fined for absence or tardiness to any National meeting or event, or for missed deadlines, in accordance with the fees listed in the National Standing Rules.
2. The National Board reserves the right to charge an additional fee of \$25 or the amount charged by the bank, whichever is greater, for any returned payments, incomplete transfers, and/or bounced checks.
3. The National Board reserves the right to charge a late fee of 5% of each amount past due. This late fee will be applied as soon as the amount is considered past due, and every 12 months thereafter.
4. Any fines collected from members during a Prospective Chapter Pledgeship will be donated to the new chapter once established. If the Prospective Chapter is unable to establish a chapter for any reason, the fines collected will be added to the SON Member Scholarship Fund.

Section E. Notice of Deposit

Any individual or Chapter making a deposit into the National Board account shall notify the National Vice President of Finance of the deposit within 24 hours. A copy of the bank receipt signed by the individual or Treasurer of the Chapter making the deposit shall be presented to the National Vice President of Finance no later than the next National Board meeting. Any deposits unaccounted for by the following National Board meeting shall be considered a donation to the National Board.

Section F. Financial Contract

In the event that a Member of the National Board or a Chapter is not able to pay off her existing account

balance at once, she may choose to set up a Financial Contract with the National Vice President of Finance.

Article XIII. Meetings

Section A. Executive Cabinet Meetings

1. The Executive Cabinet shall hold a meeting a minimum of once every three months. Executive Cabinet meetings are held via conference call or another virtual platform. Should the Executive Cabinet need to meet in-person, the National President will call the in person meeting to order with at minimum a 3-month notice.
2. Meetings are not open to Sigma Omega Nu membership at large. Individual Sisters may attend an Executive Cabinet meeting only if invited by the Executive Cabinet for a specific purpose.

Section B. National Board Meetings

1. National Board Meetings shall be held monthly and require the attendance of the Executive Cabinet and Directors. Members at Large are not required to attend National Board Meetings. National Board Meetings can be held in-person or via other virtual platform, as agreed upon by the National Board Officers. Meetings are open to any Sister in Good Standing in accordance with her designated status.
2. During the planning phases of any National $\Sigma\Omega N$ events, the National Board Representative from the host Chapter may be required to attend National Board meetings to provide updates and answer questions. If she is unable to attend, the event chair should attend in her place. If both are unable to attend, the Chapter's National Board Representative must fully inform the National Director of Social Affairs of the event's status of the prior to the date of the meeting.

Section C. National Council Meetings

1. The National Council will meet four (4) times each year: once during the following months: January (Sunnies Summit), April (Battle of the Chapters), August (National Convention), and November (Executive Retreat).
2. National Council Meetings shall require the attendance of the Executive Cabinet, Directors, Members at Large, and one Chapter Representative. The Chapter Representatives must be the Chapter's elected National Board Representative.
3. Only the elected National Board Representative will be counted for purposes of quorum. If the elected Representative is unable to attend, the Chapter must identify an additional Executive Board officer to serve as a proxy and must then notify the National Vice President of Communications and the National Vice President of Parliament a minimum of 1 week prior to the National Council meeting.
4. In addition to the usual National Board meeting agenda, it will be at this meeting that any proposals to revise any of Sigma Omega Nu's governing documents may be presented, discussed and voted on. Changes to governing documents will not be entertained at any other meeting. It is the responsibility of each National Board Officer and Chapter Representative to ensure they are prepared to discuss and vote on each proposal presented. No properly submitted proposal will be tabled due to lack of preparation on behalf of the attendees. Any proposals must be submitted to the National Board Vice President a minimum of one month prior to a National Council meeting. See the National Standing Rules for Proposal Procedures.

Section D. National Convention

The National Convention shall be composed of two parts: the National Conference, and the National Council Meeting.

1. The National Conference
The annual National Conference shall be held during the month of August, at a location determined by the National Executive Cabinet.
2. The National Council Meeting

This meeting of the National Council shall be the meeting at which the newly elected National Board officers take office and at which the Regional Directors are elected.

Section E. Dress Code

All members attending National Board and National Council meetings shall dress in business casual or business professional attire.

Section F. Meeting Agenda Addition

1. It shall be the responsibility of each National Board Officer who would like to be on any National Board meeting agenda to contact the National Vice President of Communications at least four days prior to any scheduled National meeting to be included on the agenda.
2. If any Member of the Sorority has an issue they would like addressed or reviewed by the National Board, the Member must have first attempted to address the issue through any identified appeal processes at the Chapter level prior to raising it to the National Board. If all relevant appeal processes at the Chapter level have been exhausted, the Member may request to have their issue added to the next National Board meeting agenda by contacting the National Vice President of Communications at least four days prior to any scheduled National Board meeting to be included on the agenda. For appeals related to Judicial Review sanctions, follow the appeal process outlined in the Judicial Review process.

Section G. President and Vice President Absence

In the event that both the National President and the National Vice President are unable to attend or will be late to a National Board meeting the National Vice President of Parliament shall conduct the National Board Meeting.

Section H. Parliamentary Procedures

Robert's Rules of Order shall be referred to for all parliamentary procedures not covered by the National Board Bylaws or Standing Rules.

Section I. Quorum

A quorum shall consist of 2/3rds or 66.6% of the National Board members required to attend the meeting. The required number of attendees varies by meeting type, in accordance with Article VIII Responsibilities & Duties, Section C. Attendance.

Article XIV. Committees

Section A. Formation

Only the National Board Officers shall have the power to form committees, as deemed appropriate to carry out the purposes of the National Board. The formation of a new National Committee may be proposed during any National Board or National Council meeting. A simple acknowledgement of the Committee from the National President is the only thing required for the Committee to be officially formed.

Section B. Committee Chair and Members

Only National Board Officers are eligible to chair a National Board Committee, while the National President shall always act as an ex-officio member. National Board Committees may consist of National Board Members, Active Members and Alumnae Members of Sigma Omega Nu.

Section C. Responsibilities of Chair

The Chair must maintain a record of actions through meeting minutes, receipts, photographs, and/or reports, as is appropriate for the purpose of the Committee. This shall be used for reference in order to assist members in the future. The Chair must provide status reports at each National Board and National Council Meeting.

Section D. Restrictions

No committee shall have the power to:

1. Take any final action on any matter(s) which require the approval of the National Board officers
2. Fill vacancies on the National Board or any committee(s)
3. Amend or appeal any sigma Omega Nu Bylaws or adopt new Bylaws
4. Amend or appeal any policies of the National Board, unless the committee is established for the express purpose of developing specific policies
5. Create new committees

Article XV. Prospective Chapters

Section A. Identification

The term “Prospective Chapter” is used to refer to the group of women going through the Prospective Chapter Pledgeship process in the hopes of establishing a Chapter of Sigma Omega Nu. Only those interested ladies who have completed all requirements of the Official Interest Group process are eligible for the Prospective Chapter Pledgeship process. Each Prospective Chapter will be recognized by a sequential letter of the Greek alphabet, as described in the Expansion Pledgeship Standardization.

Section B. Administration

The Prospective Chapter Pledgeship process shall be run by the elected Prospective Chapter Director(s), and shall follow the process as outlined in the Expansion Pledgeship Standardization. The National Board shall oversee the entire Prospective Chapter Pledgeship process.

Section C. Involvement

See the Undergraduate Expansion Process for participation requirements.

Article XVI. Chapters

Section A. Active Undergraduate Chapter

Any Undergraduate Chapter shall be designated as an Active Chapter if all Active Members of the Chapter and the Chapter itself meets all requirements to be considered an eligible and active organization by the University at which the Chapter is located. If a Chapter is established at a University where Greek letter organizations are not recognized as student organizations, but the Chapter meets all other requirements to be an Active Chapter as identified in this Section, then the Chapter will hold Active Chapter Status.

1. Rights, Responsibilities and Duties

An Active Undergraduate Chapter will remain in Good Standing by:

- a. Comply with all governing documents and policies of Sigma Omega Nu
- b. Completion of the annual Chapter Standards evaluation
- c. Elect a Chapter Representative that represents the Chapter, in accordance with Article VII. National Officers, Section C. Members at Large, and the Chapter Bylaws, Article VII. Officers, Section D. Officer Descriptions, and fulfills the requirements identified therein
- d. Attend all National Council meetings as stated in Article XI Meetings, Section C. National Council.
- e. Attend all National ΣΩΝ events as required by Chapter Standards and Chapter/National Board Bylaws

Section B. Inactive Undergraduate Chapter

1. Any Undergraduate Chapter shall be designated as an Inactive Chapter if any of the following apply to the Chapter. In these situations, there are still members of the Sorority attending the University, but there are other reasons as to why the Chapter is not able to hold fully Active status.
 - a. All Chapter members are not currently eligible to hold Active status, as specified in Article VI

- Membership, Section B. Active Status of the Chapter Bylaws
 - b. All Chapter members are on Academic Probation, as defined by the University
 - c. The Chapter does not meet the University's requirements to be considered an eligible and active organization at the University at which the Chapter is located, with the exception of those Chapters whose University does not recognize any Greek letter organizations
 - d. The University has placed the Chapter on probation for any reason
- 2. Rights, Responsibilities and Duties
 - An Inactive Undergraduate Chapter will remain in Good Standing by:
 - a. Notifying the National Board immediately of the potential that the Chapter might fall into Inactive Chapter status, and for what reason(s).
 - b. Notifying the National Board immediately once the Chapter fully meets one of the situations above that would place the Chapter in Inactive Chapter status.
 - c. Participating in National Council meetings.
 - d. Meet with the Regional Director on a monthly basis to track progress towards full Active Chapter status.

Section C. Suspended Chapter

- 1. Any Undergraduate Chapter shall be designated as a Suspended Chapter if any of the following apply to the Chapter:
 - a. The University has suspended the Chapter pending an investigation
 - b. The University has revoked the Chapter's charter
 - c. The National Board has suspended the Chapter
- 2. Responsibilities & Restrictions
 - Regardless of reason for the Suspension of the Chapter, the following apply to the Chapter:
 - a. Comply with all University requirements to maintain recognition once the period of Suspension has ended.
 - b. Chapter President must complete monthly check ins (Virtual or In Person) with a designated member of the National Executive Cabinet
 - c. Submit agendas and minutes from the weekly General Meeting.
 - d. Prohibited from hosting recreational or rush socials with other organizations
 - e. Prohibited from pledging a new class
 - f. Prohibited from attending any Prospective Chapter events or activities
 - g. Must continue to meet all other requirements of an Active Chapter, in accordance with Section A. Active Undergraduate Chapter, above.
- 3. Responsibilities if Suspended by the University:
 - a. Comply with sanctions and/or other requirements identified by the University
 - b. Any individual member of Sigma Omega Nu specifically named by the University as part of the Chapter Suspension shall be automatically placed on Suspension status in accordance with the Chapter Bylaws.
 - c. For any members that are not specifically named by the University as part of the Chapter Suspension, the National Board will determine if those individual members can remain fully Active or if they will individually be placed on Suspension status, based on the circumstances of
 - d. the Chapter's suspension by the University. This must be decided by majority vote of the National Board Officers.
- 4. Responsibilities if Suspended by National Board:
 - a. Required to submit other information as needed by National Board Officers (ex. Financial Books, Chapter Rosters, Official Transcripts, etc.)
 - b. Required to attend National Council meetings, but not permitted to discuss, debate, or vote

Section D. Closed Chapter

1. A Closed Chapter is a Chapter that either no longer has any members attending the University or the University has closed or is no longer accredited.
2. If a Closed Chapter wishes to return to Active Chapter status, the Chapter must go through a period of re-establishment that follows the Standardized Prospective Chapter Pledgeship. See the Undergraduate Expansion Process for more information.

Section E. Omega Chapter

The Omega Chapter is to be reserved for deceased Sisters. Any deceased member of this organization shall automatically be recognized as a member of the Omega Chapter.

The following procedure is to take place immediately after knowledge of the Sister's passing:

1. The Chapter in which she was initiated is to contact the National Board informing them of their passing. The Chapter's President is the main point of contact. At minimum, the following information is to be provided immediately:
 - a. Line Information
 - b. Date of Birth & Date of Passing
2. The Chapter is to contact the family of the Sister to gather more information to provide to the National Board as soon as it is available. This additional information includes:
 - a. Cause of Death, if the family is willing to share
 - b. Date & Address of Services
 - c. Mailing Address of the Family
3. National Director of Publicity is to create an Omega Image within 48 hours of notification containing the line information, date of birth and date of passing of the deceased Sister to be used on social media and the national website. The deceased Sister is to be added to the Omega Chapter part of the National Website within 2 weeks.
4. The National Vice President of Finance is to set up an Omega Fund for the family. All funds collected will be distributed to the family after 1 month.
5. The National Vice President of Finance is to order a wreath for the funeral services containing white & yellow roses.

Article XVII. Regions

The boundaries of each region may change on a biannual basis to coincide with the term of the Regional Directors and each time a new Chapter is established. Once elected, the National President, National Vice President and National Vice President of Undergraduate Affairs will determine appropriate regions based on the current number of Active Undergraduate Chapters, as well as any prospective chapters that may be established in the coming year. Each region should have approximately the same number of Chapters, but no more than five (5). The proposed regions will be presented to the Executive Cabinet for a vote. Once approved, the National Vice President of Parliament will inform all National Board officers, as well as all National Chapter Representatives, and announce the immediate opening for nominations. Each Chapter is responsible for providing this information to its active and alumnae membership.

Article XVIII. Deactivation

1. When a member of Sigma Omega Nu no longer wishes to be a member of this Sorority, the subsequent process shall be followed.
 - a. Submit a formal letter via email to the National President requesting deactivation. The letter should state her reasons for deactivation, and must be signed and dated/
 - b. The letter will be shared with the Executive Cabinet of the initiating Chapter and the National

Executive Cabinet.

- c. The National President shall grant the member a preliminary deactivation pending an exit interview with the Sister requesting deactivation. The exit interview shall be conducted no later than three months after the request for deactivation was received.
 - d. The Executive Cabinet shall review the responses to the exit interview, and provide the most relevant information about the member's deactivation to the initiating Chapter.
 - e. The National President shall then write the official Letter of Deactivation and provide a copy to the former member, the initiating Chapter, and the National Vice President of Communications. The letter must remind the former member of her oath of confidentiality. The National President must also request the former member to return any Sorority property or paraphernalia, and will identify a method most convenient to the former member.
 - f. The National Vice President of Communications will remove the former member's contact information from the National Roster. Her nickname will also be removed from the nickname list.
2. As part of the Judicial Review process, the Judicial Review Committee (at the Chapter or National level) is permitted to submit a Recommendation for Deactivation as one of the sanctions, in addition to suspension, when appropriate. If the Recommendation for Deactivation is passed unanimously by the committee, the process is as follows:
- a. The overseer of the Judicial Review Committee shall submit a formal request via email to the National President. The request must include the following: the Official Judicial Review results, the Suspension Letter provided to the Sister, and an additional letter stating the Chapter's reasons for requesting deactivation.
 - b. The National President will share the letter with the National Executive Cabinet.
 - c. The National President shall set up an interview between the National Executive Cabinet and the Sister being recommended for deactivation.
 - d. The National Executive Cabinet shall review the documentation provided by the Chapter Sergeant at Arms or the National Vice President of Parliamentary Procedures and the responses from the Sister provided during the interview.
 - e. The National Executive Cabinet will then vote on whether or not to deactivate the Sister. A minimum of three-fourths (3/4) approval is needed to deactivate the Sister.
 - f. Should the National Executive Cabinet vote to deactivate the Sister, the National President must schedule an exit interview with the former member no later than three months after the decision was made.
 - i. Should the National Executive Cabinet vote to deactivate a Sister and should the Sister appeal the decision, a written request must be made to the Alumnae Advisory Committee. The Alumnae Advisory Committee will review the written request and decide to uphold or revoke the deactivation. To reverse the decision made by the National Executive Cabinet, a 2/3 vote will be required. Sanctions may be voted on as a whole or individually, at the discretion of the overseer of the appeal. If the vote fails, the original sanctions will be upheld.
 - ii. Should there be no active Alumnae Advisory Committee, another committee shall be formed, using the same rules as a Judicial Review Committee, but include none of the members of the original committee. This committee shall review the written request and decide to uphold or revoke the deactivation. To reverse the decision made by the National Executive Cabinet, a 2/3 vote will be required. Sanctions may be voted on as a whole or individually, at the discretion of the overseer of the appeal. If the vote fails, the original sanctions will be upheld.
 - g. The National President will provide the most relevant information about the member's deactivation to the initiating Chapter.

- h. The National President shall then write the official Letter of Deactivation and provide a copy to the former member, the initiating Chapter, and the National Vice President of Communications. The National Vice President of Communications will remove the former member's contact information from the National Roster. Her nickname will also be removed from the nickname list.

Article XIX. Amendments

Amendments to any of the Sigma Omega Nu governing documents may be proposed by any Chapter or National Board Officer. Proposed amendments to governing documents will only be accepted in accordance with the process outlined in the National Standing Rules. Proposed amendments will only be voted on during National Council Meetings at which a quorum prevails.

Section A. Amendments Proposed by a Chapter

Amendments proposed by a Chapter must first be voted on by the respective Chapter and approved with a 3/4 (75%) affirmative vote. If the 3/4 affirmative vote is received, the proposed amendment must then be submitted to the National Vice President by the identified deadline for consideration at the next National Council meeting. The proposed amendment will only be incorporated into the respective governing document if a 3/4 affirmative vote is received during the National Council Meeting.